



The Unity Dash serves as a centralized search for files both local and remote.

commonly used applications. The top bar is the Unity Panel. The Unity Panel has a two-fold purpose – to display the application indicators for time, battery, network status, Bluetooth, locale (along with third-party ones for displaying CPU temperature, screen brightness or the weather) and also to display the currently focused application's menu bar. The menu bar for any application window is detached from the window itself and is pinned to the top– a feature called a 'Global Menu'. The highlight of Unity, however, is hidden away. It's activated only when a user clicks on the 'Ubuntu button' (the topmost button in the launcher) or presses the Super key. A translucent window called the Unity Dash opens up, from where the user can search for both locally stored and remote information such as documents, media, applications, bookmarks etc. The addition of Unity Scopes in Ubuntu 13.04 gave the Dash some more firepower– Scopes are different categories of search results such as a YouTube scope for online videos, an Amazon Scope for products or a Soundcloud scope for online audio.

3. KDE

KDE is one of the oldest Desktop Environments out there, and the GNOME/KDE rivalry is rivalled only by the Emacs/Vim one. Users coming from a GNOME background will notice a stark difference in the appearance, default applications and even basic interface elements such as the desktop, widgets, file manager and the KDE Menu. Over many years, KDE has evolved to become somewhat similar to Windows in its desktop interface. Both